MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BADGE, BADGE CLASP, BAR AND PENDANT, QUALIFICATION, GENERAL SPECIFICATION FOR

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers qualification badges, qualification clasps, qualification bars and qualification pendants for personnel within the Department of Defense.

1.2 Classification. The badges, clasps, bars and pendants covered by this specification shall be as specified on the applicable Military Specification Sheet (see 2.1 and 6.2).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be used in improving this document should be addressed to: Director, The Institute of Heraldry, US Army, Cameron Station, Alexandria, VA 22304-5050, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 8455

AMSC N/A

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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

UU-P-553 - Paper, Wrapping, Tissue
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Set Up
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Set-up, Paperboard
PPP-T- 45 - Tape, Gummed, Paper, Reinforced and Plain, for Sealing and Securing

MILITARY

MIL-F-495 - Finish, Chemical, Black for Copper Base Alloy
MIL-M-3946 - Medals, Campaign and Service, General Specification for
MIL-R-11589 - Ribbons, Awards, General Specification for

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-151 - Metals; Test Method

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads
MIL-STD-2073-1 - DoD Material Procedures for Development and Application of Packaging Requirements.

SPECIFICATION SHEETS

(See supplement 1 for list of associated specifications).

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect on the date of the solicitation.

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DRAWINGS

THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY

B-13- 5 - Attaching Devices, Heraldic, Pin and Catch Type
B-13-12 - Attaching devices, heraldic, prong and clutch type

STANDARD COLOR CHIP SET

THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY, U.S. ARMY STANDARD COLOR CHIP SET

(The standard color chips(s) may be obtained from the procuring activity for Government procurements).

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and specification sheets required by the contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer).

(Figures 1 and 2 are miniature copies of the referenced drawings and are for information only).

2.2 Other publications. The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS shall be the issue of the nongovernment documents which is current on the date of the solicitation.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS

ASTM-D-3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging.
ASTM-B-487 - Metal and Oxide Coating Thickness by Microscopical Examination of A cross Section, Measurement of

(Application for copies of ASTM publications should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19103-1187).

(Nongovernment standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations which prepare or which distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

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2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, (except for associated detail specifications, specification sheets or MS standards) the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Specification sheets. The individual item requirements shall be as specified herein and in accordance with the applicable specification sheets. In the event of any conflict between requirements of this specification and the specification sheets, the latter shall govern.

3.2 Standard sample. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the contracting officer will furnish a standard sample which shall be used for matching the color and finish only. Detail requirements or any exception applicable to a specific badge, clasp, bar or pendant shall be specified on the applicable specification sheet. In the event of conflict between the requirements of this specification and a specification sheet, the specification sheet shall govern, except the design as shown on the specification sheet is intended for illustration purposes only. The design is controlled by the Government furnished hub (3.8).

3.3 First article sample. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), before production is commenced, a sample of the finished item shall be submitted or made available to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for inspection and tests as specified in 4.4. The approval of the first article sample authorizes the commencement of production but does not relieve the contractor of responsibility for compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification. The first article sample shall be manufactured by the contractor in the same facilities to be used for the manufacture of the production items.

3.4 Materials. Materials shall conform to the referenced specifications and the requirements specified herein.

3.4.1 Copper base alloy. The copper base alloy shall be roll polished, free from pits, scale (including red oxide), dents, nicks, scratches, cracks, segregations and foreign inclusions that will not be removed in later processing. When tested as specified in 4.6.1, the chemical composition of the applicable copper base alloy shall be as specified in table I.

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TABLE I. Chemical composition of copper base alloy.

Alloy	Copper	Nickel 1/	Lead (max)	Iron (max)	Manganese (max)	Zinc	Others (max)
Yellow brass	64.0 to 68.5	-	.15	.05	-	Remainder	.15
Red brass	84.0 to 86.0	-	.05	.05	-	Remainder	.15
Gilding metal	94.0 to 96.0	-	.03	.05	-	Remainder	.13
Bronze	89.0 to 91.0	-	.05	.05	-	Remainder	.13
Nickel silver	63.0 to 2/ 66.5	16.5 to 3/ 19.5	.10	.25	.50	Remainder	
Low brass	78.5 to 81.5	-	.05	.05	-	Remainder	.15

1/ Cobalt counting as nickel.
2/ Copper content for the nickel silver pin only may be 53.5 to 56.5%.
3/ When nickel silver is used as a base material the nickel content shall be not less than 18%.

3.4.2 Gold.

3.4.2.1 Gold filled. Gold alloy when used as a material of construction shall be of the karat quality or fineness specified on the applicable specification sheet.

3.4.2.2 Gold for plating. Gold for plating shall be 24 karat.

3.4.3 Silver.

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3.4.3.1 Silver filled material. When silver filled material is specified the silver overlay shall be not less than 92.5 percent pure silver. The base of the silver filled material shall be any copper base alloy having a specific density of not less than .314 pounds per cubic inch and a copper content of not less than 96 percent pure copper.

3.4.3.2 Silver for plating. Silver for plating shall be not less than 99.5 percent pure silver.

3.4.4 Solder.

3.4.4.1 Soft solder. Soft solder shall be a lead-tin alloy having a melting point of not less than 375 degrees F.

3.4.4.2 Hard solder. Hard solder shall be an alloy of silver having a melting point of not less than 1065 degrees F.

3.4.4.3 Gold solder. Gold solder shall be a gold colored alloy of gold having a melting point of not less than 1065 degrees F.

3.4.5 Enamel.

3.4.5.1 Hard enamel. Hard enamel shall be a glass, vitreous type enamel fused with metallic oxides to produce the required color, shade and opacity or translucence.

3.4.5.2 Soft enamel. Soft enamel shall be a baking enamel pigmented to produce the required color and shade.

3.4.5.2.1 Subdued insignia. The enamel for subdued insignia shall be a flat synthetic, baking enamel pigmented to the specified shade of brown, green or black. The shade shall match the following standards established in FED-STD-595 as follows:

Brown - 20095
Black - 37038
Green - 34096

3.4.6 Lacquer. Lacquer shall be a pale, clear, synthetic lacquer. The use of pigmented lacquers shall not be permitted.

3.5 Design. The embossed designs of the badges, badge clasps, bars or pendants shall be exact replicas of the designs on the Government loaned hubs (see 3.8) from which the contractor's working dies shall be extracted. Dikes in the Government furnished dies may not be deep enough to hold the enamel in which case they must be reworked to achieve the proper depth. When furnished the Government dies may be used as production dies.

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3.6 Construction.

3.6.1 Stamping, trimming and piercing. The embossed die shall be struck in such a manner to insure a well defined die struck edge. The badges, badge clasps, bars or pendants shall be trimmed and when applicable pierced to the die struck outline of the area specified. All edges shall be clean, smooth and free from burrs, drag, step and rough edges. The stamping, trimming and, when applicable, piercing operations shall not damage or distort the design or alter the shape of the badges, badge clasps, bars or pendants.

3.6.2 Soldering. Unless otherwise specified on the applicable specification sheet, all solder shall be hard solder (silver solder for silver colored items and gold solder for gold colored items) as specified in 3.4.4.2 or 3.4.4.3 as applicable. When soldering is specified for joining a superimposed device to the badge the soldering shall be accomplished using soft solder specified in 3.4.4.1 and complete contact shall be made between the soldered parts. Soldered connections shall be completely joined without excess solder and all excess flux shall be removed. Joints shall be clean, strong, smooth and free from burned or reduced areas. When tested as specified in 4.6.2, the soldered connections shall not crack or separate.

3.6.3 Forcers. Unless otherwise specified on the applicable specification sheet, the use of mock forcers shall not be permitted. When mock forcers are permitted, the forcer shall be used only on the areas specified and there shall be no sharp or rough edges or corners. The impression of the forcers shall be regular and symmetrical upon the back of the item and sufficient metal shall be left to insure clean smooth trimming.

3.6.4 Attaching devices. Attaching devices shall be prong and clutch type, pin and catch type, or prong with pick and ball type clutch, as specified on the applicable specification sheet.

3.6.4.1 Prong and clutch type. Prong and clutch type attaching devices shall be constructed as shown on figure 2 shall be located as specified on the applicable specification sheet. Unless otherwise specified on the applicable specification sheet the prongs shall be fabricated from nickel silver or brass and shall be 5/16 plus or minus 1/64 inch long. The prongs shall be soldered or electronically fused in the locations specified. When tested as specified in 4.6.9 the fused prong shall not separate at the fused joint. The clutches shall be made from any type brass. When tested as specified in 4.6.4 it shall not be possible to remove the clutch by hand without first depressing the release wings.

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3.6.4.2 Pin and catch type. Pin and catch type attaching devices shall conform to figure 1 and except as otherwise specified on the applicable specification sheet shall be made from nickel silver. The joint and catch shall be soldered or electronically fused to the back of the item using silver or gold solder as applicable. The rotor of the catch shall remain well seated, having a close sliding fit and the joint shall remain firmly closed. The pin shall extend not less than 1/32 inch beyond the rotor of the catch and not more than 1/32 inch beyond the catch. When tested as specified in 4.6.3, the pin, joint and catch shall show no indication of looseness.

3.6.4.3 Jump rings and suspension links. Unless otherwise specified on the applicable specification sheet, jump rings and suspension links shall be fabricated from .040 +.005 -.003 inch diameter wire of the same material as the basic badge or badge clasps. The rings and suspension links shall be oval, .220 + .020 inch in length by .180 +.020, -.000 inch in width. The ends of the rings and links may be straight or bias cut but shall be aligned and together.

3.6.4.4 Lugs. Unless otherwise specified on the applicable specification sheet all lugs shall be .125 inch plus or minus .005 inch in outside diameter and the inside diameter shall be .060 + .005 inch. The thickness of all lugs shall be .035 + .005 inch. The distance on centers shall be as specified on the applicable specification sheet. Unless otherwise specified, all lugs shall be an integral part of the item. At the option of the manufacturer, the lug may be cut into his working die or may be formed from salvage during his trimming operation.

3.6.4.5 Prong with pick and ball type clutch. When a prong with pick and ball type clutch is specified, the attaching device shall conform to details and dimensions of figure 2. When tested as specified in 4.6.4, it shall not be possible to remove the clutch by hand without first pulling out on the back. White metal flat ball clutches shall be used on badges having a silver plated finish and red brass flat ball clutches shall be used on brass or gold plated badges.

3.7 Finish. Unless otherwise specified, the front and edges (surfaces visible from the front) shall be finished as specified on the applicable specification sheet and shall match the color and finish of the standard (see 3.2) or the approved (see 3.3 sample. Where plating or oxidizing is specified the entire item (front, back, and edges) except for the attaching devices, shall be plated or oxidized as applicable. The finish on the backs of gold plated items shall match the standard sample. Unless otherwise specified on the applicable specification sheet the backs of all oxidized items shall be clean i.e., uniformly oxidized. In addition to the finish specified on the specification sheets all unplated brass and silver items shall be completely

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coated with lacquer specified in 3.4.6. Unless otherwise specified on the applicable specification sheet jump rings and suspension links shall have the same finish as the pendant, badge clasp, or suspension bar to which it is attached.

3.7.1 Pebbling. All pebbling shall be distinctly and evenly grained in the areas specified. When pebbling is specified and is not in the government furnished hub, it shall be added to the contractor's working die in the areas indicated on the applicable specification sheet.

3.7.2 Enameling. Unless otherwise specified on the applicable specification sheet all enameling shall be accomplished using hard enamel. Enamel shall be applied so as to be uniform in color, free from bubbles, foreign inclusions, cracking, crazing, or other defects which might affect appearance. There shall be no overrunning of enamel.

3.7.2.1 Colors. Enamel colors shall approximate the shades specified on the applicable specification sheet by chip numbers and shall match the standard (see 3.2) or approved (see 3.3) sample. The chip numbers specified are from The Institute of Heraldry, US Army color chip set (see 2.2).

3.7.2.2 Hard enameling. Hard enamel specified in 3.4.5.1 shall be charged, fired, and unless otherwise specified, stoned level with the dikes. The enamel shall then be lapped, felted, or wheel polished to produce a glass like finish.

3.7.2.3 Soft enameling. Soft enamel shall be as specified in 3.4.5.2. When tested as specified in 4.6.7, no color shall be transferred to the cotton and the enameled surface shall remain unaffected except for a slight loss of luster.

3.7.3 Lacquering. The front, back and edges of all silver or silver plated badges shall be coated with clear lacquer specified in 3.4.6. Gold, gold plated and rhodium plated badges may be coated with clear lacquer at the option of the manufacturer. The lacquer film shall be continuous, level, adherent and free from lint, dust and other foreign matter. When tested as specified in 4.6.6.1, there shall be no change in the appearance of the clear lacquer surface except a slight overall yellowing of the highlights. When tested as specified in 4.6.6.2, the tissue paper shall not adhere to the clear lacquered surface.

3.7.4 Plating. All plating shall be by electroplating methods. the plating shall be continuous and unbroken over the entire plated surface. There shall be no cut-through, shaded, peeled, or blistered plating. Electroplating of attaching devices will not be required.

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3.7.4.1 Gold plating. The gold specified in 3.4.2.2, shall be used for gold plating. Items to be plated shall be cleaned of all matter that may affect the gold plating. The use of white metals as an undercoating for gold shall not be permitted. No visible chemical reaction shall appear when the gold plating is tested as specified in 4.6.5.

3.7.4.2 Rhodium plating. When tested as specified in 4.6.5 or 4.6.8 no chemical reaction shall occur. When rhodium plating is required over brass an undercoating of hot nickel shall be required.

3.7.4.3 Silver plating. When silver plating is specified, silver specified in 3.4.3.2, shall be used for plating. After finishing, the silver plating shall be not less than 0.0003 inch thick. Items made of brass shall be silver thickness tested on their obverse side. In case of a dispute, testing shall be conducted in accordance with ASTM Test Method B487.

3.7.4.4 Hot nickel underplating. When nickel plating is specified on the applicable specification sheet, the underplating shall be not less than 0.00025 inch. Testing shall be standard commercial. In case of a dispute, testing shall be in accordance with ASTM Test Method B487.

3.7.5 Subdued insignia. The face and edges of all subdued insignia shall be coated with enamel specified in 3.4.5.2.1. Prior to enameling the entire insignia shall be given a black chemical finish conforming to MIL-F-495. When tested as specified in 4.6.10, the baked enamel shall not flake or chip. When tested as specified in 4.6.7, only a slight amount of color shall be permitted to transfer to the cotton.

3.8 Government loaned property. Hubs will be furnished by the Government and shall be used only for making the contractor's working dies. The contractor's stamping or embossing dies shall be tooled and polished to remove any dents, nicks, scratches, or other imperfections and the unornamented sections shall be smooth and polished. The tooling and polishing shall not be done to the point where the edges or details of the design fail to be true impressions of the hub furnished by the Government. Hubs will be used for the making of the contractor's working dies necessary for one contract or order.

3.9 Weight. When weight is specified on the specification sheet, the weight specified does not include clutches but does include prongs and other attaching devices. The weight shall be determined by weighing 12 badges, clasps, bars or pendants of one type and finding the average weight.

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3.10 Marking for identification. The contractor shall stamp his trade or other identifying mark, the letters GI (GI for Government procurement only), and any fineness or quality marking necessary legibly and inconspicuously on the back of each item. When practical the items will be stamped in the forced area. Silver filled insignia may be marked in any of the following ways: 1/20 S. F., 1/20 Sil Filled, or 1/20 silver filled.

3.11 Workmanship. The finished item shall be clean, well made, and shall conform to the acceptable quality levels established by this specification.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items shall meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).

b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.3 Inspection conditions. Unless otherwise specified, all inspections shall be performed in accordance with the test conditions specified in 4.5 and 4.6 in this specification.

4.4 First article inspection. Inspection and testing of the first article shall be made on a completely finished item for all provisions of this specification applicable to end product examination and tests.

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4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Inspection shall be in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.5.1 Inspection of components.

4.5.1.1 Testing of components. In addition to the quality assurance provisions of the subsidiary specifications and drawings, inspection shall be performed on components and materials listed in table II for the test characteristics shown therein. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the requirements are applicable to lot average.

TABLE II. Component testing.

Component and lot expressed in terms of	Characteristic	Rqm't para	Test method	Rqm't applicable to lot average	#determs per s/u	Results reported as	S/U
Copper base alloy (as applicable)(1 lb)	Chemical composition	3.4.1	4.6.1	x	2 composite	Nearest 0.1% each element	4 oz. of composite
Gold used for plating (1 oz)	Karat	3.4.2	Std Comm'l	x	2 composite	Nearest 0.1%	1/2 oz
Gold used for construction (1 oz.)	Karat	3.4.2	Std comm'l	x	2 composite	Nearest 0.1%	1 oz.
Silver for plating	Fineness	3.4.3.2	Std comm'l	x	2 composite	Nearest 0.1%	1 oz.
Silver filled material 1/	Chemical composition	3.4.3.1	Std comm'l	x	2 composite	Nearest 0.1%	1 oz.

1/ Material so indicated may be accepted on a contractor's certificate of compliance, based upon the quality markings on the badges, badge clasps, pendants, and bars.

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4.5.1.2 Certification of compliance. Materials listed below may be accepted on the basis of a contractor's certification of compliance for requirements specified in the applicable paragraphs of this specification.

Component	Characteristics	Rqm't para
Gold alloy	Material identification and karat	3.4.2.1
Gold for plating	Material identification and karat	3.4.2.2
	White metal not used as undercoating	3.7.4.1
Soft solder	Material identification	3.4.4.1
Hard solder	Material identification	3.4.4.2
Gold solder	Material identification	3.4.4.3
Hard enamel	Material identification	3.4.5.1
Soft enamel	Material identification	3.4.5.2
Lacquer	Material identification	3.4.6
Silver for plating	Material identification and fineness	3.4.3.2

4.5.2 In-process inspection. Inspection shall be made at any point or during any phase of the manufacturing process to determine whether operation or assemblies are accomplished as specified. The Government reserves the right to exclude from consideration for acceptance any material for which in-process inspection has indicated nonconformance. In-process inspection shall be conducted to see that accomplishment of the following is in accordance with the specification requirements:

Requirement, operation or assembly	Characteristics	Requirement paragraph
Gold soldering of pins to targets	Use of gold solder	Applicable specification sheet
Silver soldering of rivets to missile	Use of silver solder	3.4.4.2
Hot nickel plating	Used as an underplating	3.7.4.2
Black chemical finish	Used as a base	3.7.5

4.5.3 Inspection of the end item.

4.5.3.1 Visual examination of badges, pendants, badge clasps, and bars. Examination shall be made at a distance of approximately 16 to 18 inches with illumination equal to average daylight and arranged so as to avoid as much reflected light as possible. All defects shall be classified as indicated in 4.5.3.1.1.

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4.5.3.1.1 Examination of badges, pendants, badge clasps, and bars for defects in finish, design, material, construction, workmanship, and marking. Defects designated by an asterisk (*) shall be classified as major when seriously affecting appearance or serviceability and minor when affecting appearance or serviceability but not seriously.

TABLE III. End Item Visual Defects

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	(*)	Minor
Front:				
Color and finish	Poor match to the standard or approved guide sample	x	-	-
	Does not match the standard or approved guide sample as follows:			
	The oxidized finish, when required, has not been sufficiently relieved, or has been excessively relieved.	-	*	-
	Is not highlighted to the same extent as the standard or approved guide sample.	-	*	-
	Foreign matter embedded	-	*	-
	Background or recessed areas are not finished as specified, e.g., are not pebbled when required.	x	-	-
	Pebbling (when required) is not finely and evenly grained	-	*	-
	Jump rings and suspension links as applicable are not finished as specified.	-	*	-
	Surface contains pits, scale, nick, scratch, crack, machine mark	-	*	-
	Pinhole, rupture, segregation, or other blemish.	-	*	-
	Buff drag, blushed, or cloudy finish.	-	*	-
	Discolored, i.e., spot, stain, or speck	-	*	-
	Not clean	-	*	-
Plating	Not plated (when required).	x	-	-
	Not type specified.	x	-	-
	Plating is not smooth, not continuous or not adherent.	x	-	-
	Cut through or porous, pitted or crystallized	x	-	-
Enamel	Not enameled (when required).	x	-	-
	Any enamel that is not contained within the prescribed outline of the design	x	-	-
	Wrong color	x	-	-

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Examine	Defect	Classification		
		Major	(*)	Minor
	Wrong shade	x	-	-
	Cracked, chipped, or crazed	-	*	-
	Bubbles, lumps, or foreign inclusion.	-	*	-
	Not stoned smooth (when required), e.g. is coarse or uneven.	-	*	-
	Is not level with the dikes, e.g., contains high or low spots	-	*	-
	Hole or blister	-	*	-
	Laps, overruns, or skips.	-	*	-
	Fishscale, copperheads, burnoffs, scale specking, discoloration, scumming, or lack of gloss.	-	*	-
Lacquering	Not lacquered (when required)	x	-	-
	Areas of no lacquer	-	*	-
	Lacquer forms noticeable runs, or sharp coarse particles	-	*	-
	Lacquer not set to touch i.e., is tacky when gentle pressure is applied.	-	-	x
	Coating is not smooth and adherent, e.g., is flaking, blistering, or peeling	-	*	-
	Coating has rainbow effect.	-	*	-
Design	Detail altered and does not conform to Government hub.	x	-	-
	Any warp, twist, or distortion producing irregular surface contour or outline	-	*	-
	Any significant detail obliterated or reduced.	x	-	-
	Detail struck over, resulting in a double impression.	x	-	-
	Lugs not of specified design and type	x	-	-
	Not as specified.	x	-	-
Material	Jump rings and suspension links (unless otherwise specified) are not made from wire of the same material as the bar, pendant, badge, or clasp to which assembled.	x	-	-
Quality of metal	Surface pitted, porous, crystalline, spotted, or opened grained	x	-	-
Construction and workmanship	Any component (including jump rings and suspension bar balls) missing, twisted, bent out of shape, malformed or deformed.	x	-	-

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Examine	Defect	Classification Major	(*)	Minor
	Not connected or joined as specified, or operation is poorly accomplished, e.g., ends of jump rings not closed (when required) or not in alignment.	-	*	-
	Not trimmed to the die struck edge. . . .	-	*	-
	Dyke or letter distorted.	x	-	-
	Not pierced where required.	x	-	-
	Piercing not clean and smooth, e.g., any burrs, cutter drill, or file marks . . .	-	*	-
	Design or shape altered by piercing . . .	-	*	-
	Any rough or ragged edge, drag, or step .	-	*	-
	Any solder spatter on front, exposed, or concealed by plating.	x	-	-
	Solder does not completely unite component parts.	-	*	-
	Area burned or reduced in soldering . . .	-	*	-
	Incorrect type of solder used, e.g., silver solder in lieu of gold solder . .	x	-	-
	Surface or edge not clean, not smooth or not free from burrs, roughness, drag, step or tool marks	-	*	-
	Metal marks on exposed surface, such as nick, dent, dig, gouge or scratch. . . .	-	*	-
	Superimposed design, when applicable, not centered or not positioned on badge as required	-	*	-
	Superimposed design is not securely riveted to badge (when applicable), i.e., rivet is loose, poorly or insufficiently peened or swaged	x	-	-
	Riveted design is not closely fitted to the badge.	-	*	-
Cleanness	Spatter or discoloration on edge, less than 3/32 inch in length clearly noticeable	-	*	-
	Spatter or discoloration on edge 3/32 inch or more in length	x	-	-
Back and edges: Color and finish	Not clean	-	*	-
	Pit, scale, nick, crack, machine mark, pinhole, rupture, segregation, or other blemish.	-	-	x

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Examine	Defect	Classification		
		Major	(*)	Minor
	Buff drag, blushed, or cloudy finish. . .	-	-	x
	Foreign matter embedded, affecting appearance	-	-	x
	Discoloration, spot, or stain affecting appearance	-	-	x
Plating	Not plated when required.	x	-	-
	Not type specified.	x	-	-
	Plating is not continuous, or is cut through, porous or is not adherent . . .	x	-	-
Lacquering	Coating is not adherent, e.g., is blistered, flaking, or peeling	-	*	-
Fastening device	Fastening device not specified type, size, or material.	x	-	-
	Any component missing	x	-	-
	Defective, e.g., any part damaged or malformed affecting use.	-	*	-
	Not positioned as specified, or components are off center by 1/8 inch or more . . .	-	*	-
	Pin protrudes less than 1/32 inch beyond the safety catch	x	-	-
	Pin protrudes more than 1/32 inch beyond the safety catch	-	-	x
	Pin bent or blunted affecting use	-	*	-
	Clutch will not engage prong, or is loose fit.	x	-	-
	Prong is loose.	x	-	-
	Prong is bent out of shape, or is otherwise impaired	-	*	-
Workmanship	Forcer used in other than specified location	x	-	-
	Impression of forcer is not symmetrical upon the back.	-	*	-
	Back not flat or smooth when required . .	-	-	x
	Edges of forced area are not clean and smooth	-	-	x
	Any sharp or rough edge, burr, drag, or step	-	*	-
	Component parts are not completely joined by solder	-	*	-
	Any area burned or reduced in soldering or acid cleaning	-	*	-

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Examine	Defect	Classification Major	(*)	Minor
	Any solder spatter exceeding 3/16 inch in maximum dimension.	-	*	-
	Flux or excess solder not removed	-	-	x
	Not connected or joined as specified or operation is poorly accomplished	-	*	-
Identification and quality marking	Missing, incorrect, illegible, misspelled, not accomplished as specified, or not placed as required	-	-	x

4.5.3.1.2 Examination of badges, pendants, badge clasps, and bars for defects in dimensions. Except for Marine Corps precious metal competition badges, any dimension that is not within the specified tolerances shall be classified as a defect.

4.5.3.1.3 Examination for weight. Except for Marine Corps precious metal competition badges, the badges, pendants, clasps, and bars shall be examined to determine the average weight. The sample unit shall be 12 each badges, pendants, clasps, or bars of the same type and material. The average weight shall be not less than that specified on the applicable specification sheet. The inspection level shall be S-1 and AQL shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units.

4.5.3.1.4 Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels. Except for Marine Corps precious metal competition badges, the inspection levels and the acceptable quality levels (AQL's) expressed in defects per hundred units shall be as follows:

	Inspection level	AQL Major	AQL Total
For examinations applicable to 4.5.3.1.1			
For precious metal items	II	0.25	10.0
For all others (including precious metal laminates)	II	2.5	15.0
For examinations applicable to 4.5.3.1.2	S-1	(one class)	2.5

4.5.3.1.5 Marine Corps precious metal competition badges. Any item with visual, dimensional or weight defects will be rejected. There will be a 100 percent inspection for these badges.

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4.5.3.2 Testing of end item. Testing of the completely fabricated badges, pendants, badge clasp and bar shall be preformed in accordance with table III. The sample unit for the test for fused joints shall be one unit. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 6.5 for fused prongs. All items shall be tested and one defect will be scored regardless of how many prongs on that item failed. The sample unit for all applicable end item test shall be four. For other than the test for fused prongs the requirements shall be applicable to the individual unit. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL shall be 2.5.

TABLE III. Testing of the end item.

Characteristic	Rqm't para	Test method	#determ per s/u	Results reported as
Test for soldered joints	3.6.2	4.6.2	1	Pass or fail
Tests for attaching devices				
Joint and catch	3.6.4.2	4.6.3	1	Pass or fail
Prong and clutch	3.6.4.1	4.6.4	1	Pass or fail
Test for soft or baked enamel	3.7.2.3 & 3.7.5	4.6.7	1	Pass or fail
Test for fused joints				
Joint and catch	3.6.4.2	4.6.3	1	Pass or fail
Prongs	3.6.4.1	4.6.9	1 1/	Pass or fail
Silver plating thickness	3.7.4.3	STD comm'l	1	Pass or fail
Lacquer tests:				
Liver of sulfur	3.7.3	4.6.6.1	1	Pass or fail
Tackiness	3.7.3	4.6.6.2	1	Pass or fail
Test for fused joints	3.6.4.1	4.6.9	1	Pass or fail
Scratch test for baked enamel	3.7.5	4.6.10	1	Pass or fail
Acid test:				
Rhodium	3.7.4.2	4.6.5	1	Pass or fail
Gold plating	3.7.4.1	4.6.5	1	Pass or fail
Test for nickel plating	3.7.4.4	STD comm'l	1	Pass or fail

1/ All Prongs each badge.

4.5.4 Examination for count of badges, badge clasps, bars, and pendants in intermediate containers. Badges, badge clasps, bars and pendants packaged for shipment shall be examined to determine conformance with package markings and specified quantity. The sample unit for this examination shall be one box (interior package). Any box containing less than the specified or marked quantity of badges, badge clasps, bars and pendants shall be classified as a defect. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units. The lot size shall be the number of intermediate containers.

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4.5.5 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per 100 units.

Examine	Defect
Markings, exterior and interior	Missing, incorrect, illegible or improper size, location sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Component missing, damaged, or otherwise defective, affecting serviceability.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of envelope and container flaps; insecure seating of fastening device; tissue wrapping incomplete; voids inadequately filled; and bulging or distortion of containers.
	Unit package not properly sealed.
Weight	Net weight exceeds requirements.

4.5.6 Palletization examination. An examination shall be made to determine that the palletization is in compliance with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load fully packaged. The lot size shall be the number of palletized unit loads in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

Examine	Defect
Finished dimensions	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirements.
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified.
	Interlocking of loads not as specified.
	Load not bonded with required straps as specified.
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits.
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application

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4.6 Tests.

4.6.1 Chemical composition test. Chemical composition shall be determined in accordance with test method number 111 of Federal Test Method Standard No. 151. Results shall be evaluated to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.4.1.

4.6.2 Test for soldered joints.

4.6.2.1 Hard solder. Hard soldered items shall be placed in an oven maintained at 1065 degree F, ± 5 degree F, for 15 minutes. While at this temperature the item shall be lifted by the attaching device and shall be inspected to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.6.2.

4.6.2.2 Soft solder. Soft soldered items shall be placed in an oven maintained at 365 degree F, ± 5 degree F, for 15 minutes. While at this temperature, the item shall be lifted by the superimposed design and shall be inspected to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.6.2.

4.6.3 Test for pins, joints and safety catches. Safety catches and pins shall be opened and closed ten times, after which the pins, joints and safety catches shall be inspected to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.6.4.2.

4.6.4 Test for clutch type attaching device. The clutches shall be removed and replaced ten times from the prong. An attempt shall then be made to remove the clutch by hand without first depressing the release wings or pulling out on the back, during which time the clutch and prong or ball clutch and prong with pick shall be inspected to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.6.4 or 3.6.4.5.

4.6.5 Acid test for gold and rhodium plating. The test acid shall be applied as follows: Place a drop of test acid (each drop shall be not less than 1/16 inch in diameter) on three different spots on the plated surface allowing the drops to remain for not less than 1 minutes, during which time the surface of the insignia shall be inspected to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.7.4.1 and 3.7.4.2. The test acid applied at room temperature shall consist of a solution containing 50 percent by volume of CP nitric acid (specific gravity 1.42) and an equal volume of distilled water. If the test insignia has been lacquered, the lacquer must be removed prior to testing.

4.6.6 Test for lacquer.

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4.6.6.1 Liver of sulphur test. Items to be tested shall be immersed in 2% by weight CP liver of sulphur (Sulfurated potash) water solution at a temperature of 100 degree F, ± 10 degree F, for a period of 3 minutes. The item shall then be removed and rinsed in warm, then cold, then hot water. The item shall be wiped gently with an absorbent cellulose material or whirled to remove residual moisture and shall be air dried at room temperature (60 degree to 80 degree F) for one hour. The item shall then be inspected to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.7.3.

4.6.6.2 Tackiness test. At room temperature (60 degree to 80 degree F) press a piece of tissue paper against the lacquered surface for 15 seconds, using any pressure capable of being exerted between thumb and two fingers, after which the pressure shall be released and the item inspected to determine compliance with the requirement specified in 3.7.3.

4.6.7 Acetone test for soft enamel. The enameled surface shall be wiped five times with a piece of cotton saturated with acetone. The cotton and enamel shall then be examined to determine compliance with 3.7.2.3 or 3.7.5 as applicable.

4.6.8 Continuity of rhodium plating. The unlacquered rhodium plated item shall be tested by immersion in a solution of liver of sulfur (2% sulfurated potash and 98% water, by weight, at a temperature of 100 degree F, ± 10 degree F) for a period of 1 minute. Upon removal the item shall be washed, cleaned, and examined for compliance with 3.7.4.2.

4.6.9 Test for electronically fused joints. Item to be tested shall be anchored on a horizontal surface. All prongs on each end item shall be grasped at least 1/3 its length above the fused joint and bent thru an angle of 90 degrees (45 degrees to each side of the vertical) until separation occurs. The fused joint shall then be examined to determine compliance with 3.6.4.1. A bending tool in the form of a 45 degrees template may be used for this test provided the prong is gripped at least 1/3 its length above the fused joint.

4.6.10 Test for baked enamel. Draw a knife edge across the face side of the specimen making four parallel scores 1/16 inch apart. Repeat this process drawing the knife edge this time perpendicular to the previously scored lines, making small blocks in the finish. The finish shall then be examined to determine compliance with 3.7.5.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be A, C or commercial as specified (see 6.2).

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5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit packaging. Unless otherwise specified on the applicable specification sheet, individual medals shall be mounted on a box pad, completely wrapped with not less than three sheets of anti-tarnish paper or heat sealed in a snug-fitting transparent polyethylene film 0.002 inch minimum thickness and packaged in a folding box conforming to variety 1, style II, type D of PPP-B-566.

5.1.1.1.1 Qualification badges. One qualification badge shall be mounted with its respective attaching device on a white sulphite board card having a minimum thickness of 0.011 inch. Each mounted badge shall then be packaged in a snug-fitting transparent polyethylene film bag. The polyethylene film shall be a minimum of 0.0015 inch thick and all seams and closures shall be effected by heat sealing. Prior to or during the heat sealing operation, excess air within the bag shall be expelled. The expert infantryman, combat infantryman, missile man, combat crewman, and Navy and Marine Corps senior parachutist badge shall be mounted on card 3-1/4 inches in length by 1-1/2 inches in width. The Marine Corps basic pistol and rifle badge shall be mounted on a card 2-1/4 inches square. All other badges shall be mounted on cards 2 inches square.

5.1.1.1.2 Qualification pendant and bars. Each pendant or bar shall be completely wrapped in not less than three thicknesses of antitarnish tissue paper conforming to type II, grade A, class of UU-P-553.

5.1.1.1.3 Qualification pendants with bars or ribbon drape and badge clasps assembled. Each assembled unit shall be mounted on a chipboard pad, covered on one side with cobalt blue colored plush or suede finish, measuring 2-15/16 by 2-1/16 inches and not less than 0.030 inch thick. The pad shall be slotted to securely seat the fastening device with the badge unit centered on the pad. Each card-mounted unit shall be completely inclosed in a wrap of not less than three thicknesses of antitarnish tissue paper conforming to type II, grade A, class 1 of UU-P-553. Each badge, so prepared, shall be packaged in a full telescope setup paperboard box. The entire box, except the inside bottom, shall be covered with cobalt blue colored embossed paper and shall have inside dimensions measuring 3 inches in length, 2-1/8 inches in width, and 1/2 inch in depth.

5.1.1.2 Intermediate packaging.

5.1.1.2.1 Qualification badges. One hundred qualification badges of one type only, prepared as specified in 5.1.1.1, shall be placed in a setup paperboard box conforming to type I, variety 1, class A, style 4 of PPP-B-676;

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or in a folding paperboard box conforming to style III, type G, class 1 of PPP-B-566. Unit packages shall be stacked on end, face to face and back to back to fill the container. Inside dimensions of each size paperboard box required shall be determined by the contractor. Any void occuring within the box shall be filled with crumpled tissue paper or other similar cushioning material to prevent the shifting of contents. Box closure shall be secured with 2 inch minimum width gummed paper tape conforming to type III of PPP-T-45 applied at the center of the length opening and extending along the bottom and up the sides at least 3 inches.

5.1.1.2.2 Qualification pendants and bars. One hundred pendants or bars of one type and style only shall be packaged in a setup paperboard box conforming to type I, variety 1, class A, style 4 of PPP-B-676. Inside dimensions of the paperboard box shall be 6-1/4 inches in length, 4-3/4 inches in width, and 1-3/4 inches in depth. Any voids occurring within the box shall be filled with crumpled tissue paper or similar cushioning material to prevent shifting of the contents. Box closure shall be secured with 2 inch minimum width gummed paper tape conforming to type III of PPP-T-45 applied at the center of the length opening and extending along the bottom and up the sides at least one inch.

5.1.1.2.3 Qualification badges clasps. Fifty badge clasps of one type only shall be wrapped in bulk in three sheets of antitarnish tissue paper conforming to type II, grade A, class 1 of UU-P-553 and placed in an end opening style kraft paper envelope having a basis weight of 28 pounds per ream (17 by 22-500). Each envelope shall have the gummed flap, clasp, or string and button secured to prevent escape of contents. Six filled and closed envelopes of clasps of one type only shall be packaged in a setup paperboard box conforming to type I, variety 1, class A, style 4 of PPP-B-676. Inside dimensions of the paperboard box shall be 4-3/4 inches in length, 4-1/8 inches in width, and 2-1/2 inches in depth. Box closure shall be secured with 2 inch minimum width gummed paper tape conforming to type III of PPP-T-45 applied at the center of the length opening and extending along the bottom and up the sides at least two inches.

5.1.2 Level C. Qualification badges, pendants, bars, and badge clasps shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with the applicable requirements of MIL-STD-2073-1.

5-1-3 Commercial. Badge, badge clasp, bar, and pendant shall be preserved in accordance with the applicable requirements of ASTM-D-3951.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

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5.2.1 Level A. Badges, pendants, bar and badge clasps or assembled units of one type only shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1, shall be packed in a snug fitting shipping container conforming to class weather resistant, V3c or V3s of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the container specification. The weight of contents of each container shall not exceed the size and weight limitation the container specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Badges, pendants, bars, clasps or assembled units of one type only, packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.3 Level C. Badges, pendants, bars, clasps or assembled units of one type only, shall be packed in accordance with the applicable requirements of MIL-STD-2073-1.

5.2.4 Commercial. Badge, badge clasp, bar and pendant shall be preserved in accordance with the applicable requirements of ASTM-D-3951.

5.3 Palletization. Unitized loads, commensurate with the level of packing specified in the contract or order, shall be palletized in accordance with MIL-STD-147. Palletized loads shall be uniform in size and quantities to the greatest extent possible. If the container is of a size which does not conform to any of the pallet patterns specified in MIL-STD-147, the pallet pattern used shall first be approved by the contracting officer.

5.4 Marking. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or purchase order, unit packages, intermediate boxes, shipping containers, and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM-D-3951, as applicable.

5.4.1 Marking for cleaning. Each mounting card/box pad for gold plated items shall have the following statement printed on the fact of the card/box pad. As an option, a slip of white paper may be inserted in each polyethlene bag. "To clean rub gently with a soft, dry cloth. Do not clean with a chemically treated cloth or abrasive."

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Qualification badges, pendants, bars, and badge clasps covered by this specification are intended to be worn by military personnel to signify the wearer has qualified in the specialty designated by the badge.

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6.2 Ordering data.

6.2.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) The number and date of the applicable specifiction sheet (see 1.2 and 2.1).
(c) When a standard sample will not be furnished (see 3.2).
(d) When a first article sample is not required (see 3.3).
(e) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(f) When palletization is required (see 5.4).

6.3 Cancellation. Military specification sheets MIL-B-3628/19 and MIL-B-3628/20 have been cancelled. The badge and clasps covered by these sheets have been removed from the supply system.

6.4 Samples. For access to guide samples, address the contracting activity issuing the invitation for bids.

6.5 First article. When a first article inspection is required, the item should be a first article sample or it may be a standard production item from the contractor's current inventory as specified in 4.4. The first article should consist of one completed badge set. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for examinations, approval of first article test results and disposition of first articles. Invitations for bids should provide that the Government reserves the right to waive the requirement for samples for first article inspection to those bidders offering a product which has been previously acquired or tested by the Government, and that bidders offering such products, who wish to rely on such production or test, must furnish evidence with the bid that prior Government approval is presently appropriate for the pending contract.

6.6 Government-loaned property. - The contracting officer should arrange to loan the property listed in 3.8.

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6.7 Subject term (key word) listing.

Badge
Badge clasp
Bar and pendant
Qualification
Suspension bars
Bars
Clasp, qualification
Badge, qualification

6.8 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks or vertical lines are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of changes.

Custodians:
Army - IH
Air Force - 11
Navy - NU

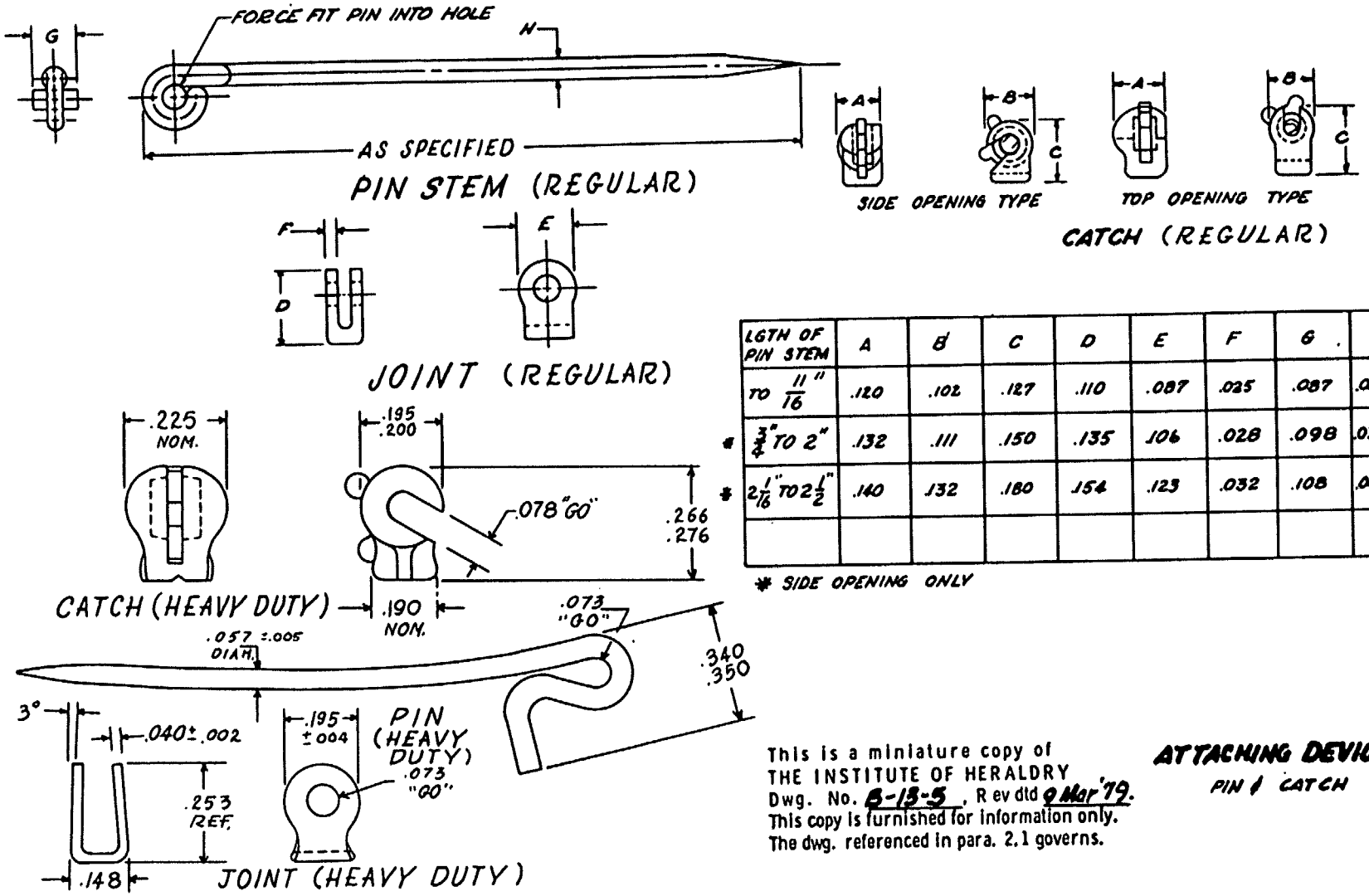
Review activities:
Air Force - 82,99
Navy - MC
DLA - CT

User activities:
Air Force - 45

Preparing activity:
Army - IH

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LGTH OF PIN STEM	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H
TO 11/16"	.120	.102	.127	.110	.087	.025	.087	.028±.002
* 3/4" TO 2"	.132	.111	.150	.135	.106	.028	.098	.036±.002
* 2 1/16" TO 2 1/2"	.140	.132	.180	.154	.123	.032	.108	.045±.002

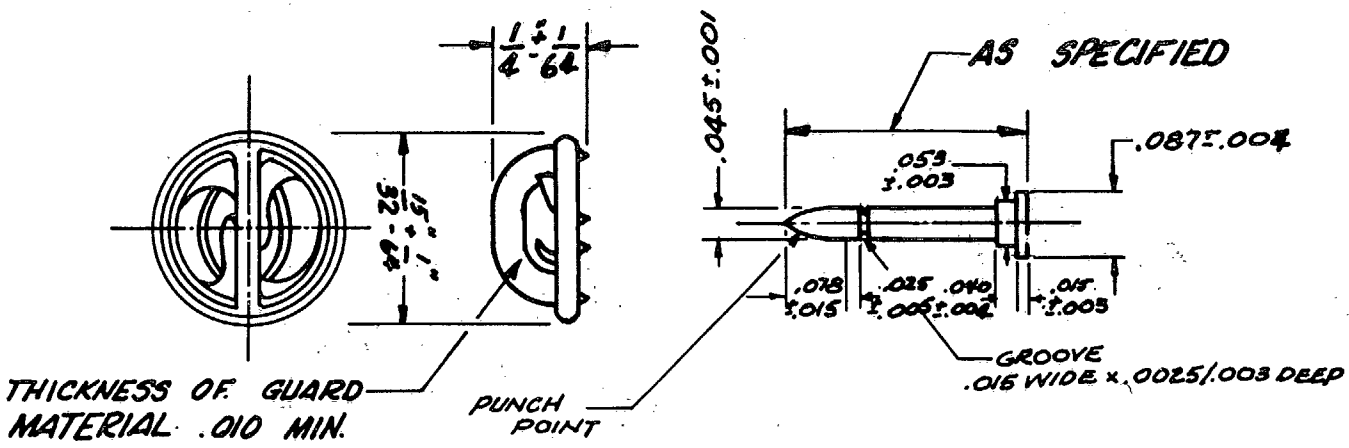
* SIDE OPENING ONLY

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ATTACHING DEVICES HERALDIC
PIN & CATCH TYPE

FIGURE 1

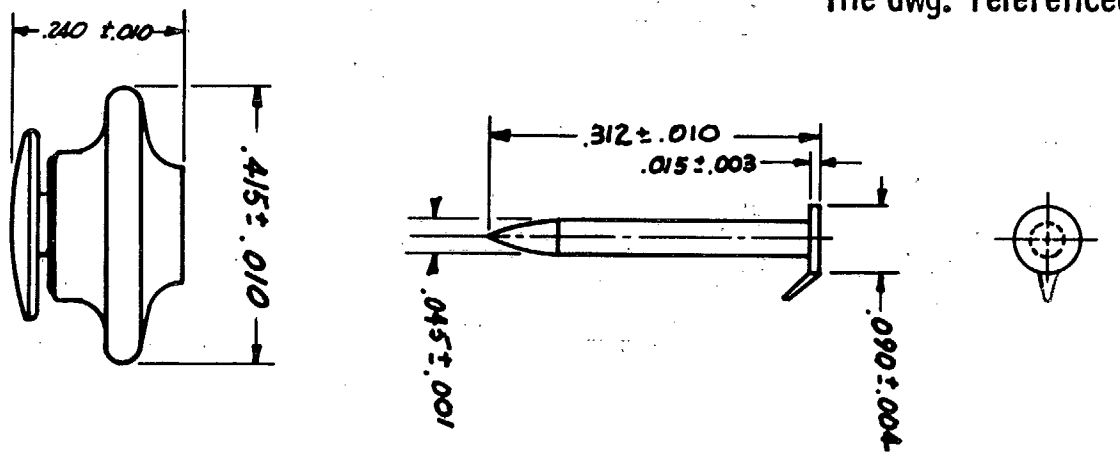
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CLUTCH

PRONG

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Dwg. No. B-13-12, Rev. dtd 16 Mar 79.
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FLAT BALL TYPE CLUTCH PRONG WITH PICK

FIGURE 2

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-B-3628E	BADGE, BADGE CLASP, BAR AND PENDANT, QUALIFICATION, GENERAL

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

DD FORM 82 MAR 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE.

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